



Flying car!

An electric, vertical take off and landing vehicle for personal use is under development by a German start up. http://dgit.in/flying_carx



NVIDIA's new graphic cards!

NVIDIA claims the 1000 series GPUs have almost irresponsible amounts of power. <http://dgit.in/gtx1080>

Bazaar

Smartron t.book

An appreciable effort

The Microsoft Surface Pro 4 and Apple iPad Pro have a lot going for them, but neither of these products were actually designed for India, and Indians. Enter, the Smartron t.book. Smartron is an India firm, which designs and engineers its products in the country. The company has already roped in Sachin Tendulkar as a strategic investor and brand ambassador. The company claims it wants to prove that Indian companies can do as well as global giants.

By the looks of it, Smartron is on the right track. The t.book is its first product, and it takes on Microsoft and Apple head on. It costs ₹39,999, including the keyboard, which is less than half of what those tablets cost, but provides many of the same things, starting with the display. At this price, there are few laptops that can come close to the t.book's display. It's got a 2K resolution, and more than acceptable viewing angles. It's not as bright as a Surface Pro 4, but it works well enough.

The device is powered by an Intel Core M5Y10-C processor, which allows it to have a fanless design. It also makes it considerably weaker than a Surface Pro 4. But at this price, the performance is quite acceptable. Laptops that can come close to its performance and form factor usually cost more, and there are no tablets that can do the same.

We wouldn't call this zippy, like the Surface, but the performance difference can be best explained by the lock and unlock times. For example, when you press the unlock button, the screen turns off, and pressing it again, takes a few seconds for the screen to come back on. On the Surface, this is almost instantaneous.

In terms of build and design, the t.book has made all the right moves. Its body is made entirely of metal, and feels premium. The silver and orange colours give it a distinct and noticeable look, but it's heavier than a Surface. Also, the kickstand is not as flexible, so the t.book can't do as many positions as the Surface does. Made of magnesium, the kickstand seems somewhat wobbly at times, and it isn't well suited for using on your lap. Neither is the Surface, but it does better.

The keyboard still needs work, though, especially the touchpad. At first, the touchpad was impossible to work with, but Smartron passed a firmware update, which made it slightly better. Still, the touchpad is a tad too sensitive and registers Windows gestures without provocation.



It's also, too small to be supremely useful. On the other hand, the keyboard is better. The pitch is right, and typing is easy. Most of the essential buttons are there, but the lack of volume up/down buttons is annoying.

Further, the Core M should ideally allow better battery life, but the Smartron t.book runs for about 4-5 hours. On streaming video continuously, the Smartron t.book lasted us between two to three and a half hours, depending on resolution and screen brightness. While typing and browsing, we were able to reach four and a half hours. Thankfully, the Smartron t.book charges using an USB Type-C port, and it can go from about zero to 100% charge in an hour, at best.

The Smartron t.book's other weakness is in audio performance. While the front facing speakers look good, they're barely audible. We were able to really use these speakers only in completely silent rooms, as in the dead of the night. Usually, during the day, the tablet needed to be attached to a speaker or headphones, for it to be audible.

The Smartron t.book has the audio jack on the right side, while there are two USB 3.0 ports on the left, along with a micro-HDMI port below them. There's also a micro-SD card reader on the left side of the tablet.

Overall, the Smartron t.book makes a lot of sense, and is a very good product to use. The company has passed two updates already, to fix issues with Cortana integration and the keyboard. We would have preferred a lower price, ished brand, we'd find it much easier to trust it.

Prasid Banerjee



Features 81
Design 77
Performance 65
Value 91

Specifications

Display: 12.2 inch WQXGA, 2560x1600p; **Processor:** Intel Core M5Y10U 64-bit; **RAM:** 4GB; **Storage:** 128GB SSD; **Camera:** 5MP, 2MP; **Operating System:** Windows 10 Home/Pro

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